



THE ADMINISTRATOR
ED NATIONS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

29 January 1985

To: Mrs. Alice Weil, Assistant Secretary-General, OGS.
From: Bradford Morse
Director, Office of Emergency Operations for Africa
Subject: Urgent office space requirement on 29th floor for Africa Emergency Information and Communication Activities

Pursuant to the Secretary-General's decision of 17 December 1984, to establish special machinery at Headquarters for the effective co-ordination of international response to the emergency situation in Africa, which included my designation as Director of OEOA, I now seek your co-operation in a priority allocation of office space on the 29th floor, for the specific purpose of Emergency Information and Communication Activities.

In the context of the Secretary-General's initiatives, and in addition to the creation of the OEOA, an emergency Working Group has been set up, comprising of senior officials from UNDP, UNDRO, UNICEF, WFP, DIEC, and SPQ whose principal task is the continuous monitoring of the emergency situation, the collection and analysis of emergency data, and the continuous production of situation reports, country briefs, and background for appeals for use by the Secretary-General and OEOA, as well as the donor community.

UNDP is chairing this Working Group and UNDRO is providing the leading input of emergency data. UNDRO's data communication links with its Geneva Headquarters and its data processing facilities in New York are now being expanded. UNDRO is fully agreeable to share such facilities with the Working Group for the purpose of centralizing emergency communication and information activities. There is however a critical problem of office space.

In his memo dated 6 December to yourself, the UNDRO Liaison Office Director had requested an additional four rooms on the 29th floor (2930 --), adjacent to his own offices (2935 A), inter alia for the installation of data-communication equipment. I understand that only one room has been allocated for the installation of the computer terminal, the telex, the Wang machine, and one operator.

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